

with *Iphigénie en Aulide* (premiered in 1774), he applied his revolutionary dramatic principles to a series of powerful works for the Parisian stage: an expanded version of *Orfeo* as *Orphée et Eurydice* (1774) and a radical French reworking of *Alceste* (1776). This was followed by the romantically colored *Armide* (1777) and *Iphigénie en Tauride* (1779), arguably his supreme masterpiece, and, like *Orfeo*, a key influence on Mozart's *Idomeneo*.

Gluck's final French opera, *Echo et Narcisse*, was a dismal failure. This was due in part to squabbling clagues (the supporters of Gluck versus those of the Italian Niccolò Piccinni) and because Gluck's French operas had accustomed his audiences to sterner stuff. In poor health, Gluck left Paris in October 1779 and spent his last years enjoying his wealth and fame in Vienna. He died, aged 73, in 1787.